

Chapter 18 — Mokṣa-Sannyāsa Yoga

మోక్షసన్యాసయోగః : మోక్షసన్యాసయోగము

"The Yoga of Liberation through Renunciation" · 78 verses · The longest chapter — the grand finale

Chapter 18 is the **grand synthesis** — the longest chapter of the Gītā (78 verses) — and Kṛṣṇa weaves together every thread He has been teaching across all 17 preceding chapters. He defines true renunciation, analyzes action under the three guṇas, describes the four divisions of human nature (varṇa) by aptitude, and reaffirms the supremacy of *svadharma*. Then He builds — verse by verse — toward what many traditions hold to be the single most important verse in the entire Gītā: **18.66, the charama-śloka** (the final / supreme verse) — the call to total surrender.

The Gītā closes with Sañjaya's promise that wherever Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna are together — there will be victory, prosperity, and lasting righteousness.

Essential verses of Chapter 18

BG 18.46 *Worship through one's own work — work as offering*

यतः प्रवृत्तिर्भूतानां येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ।

स्वकर्मणा तमभ्यर्च्य सिद्धिं विन्दति मानवः ॥ १८.४६ ॥

యతః ప్రవృత్తిర్భూతానాం యేన సర్వమిదం తతమ్ ।

స్వకర్మణా తమభ్యర్చ్య సిద్ధిం విందతి మానవః ॥ ౧౮.౪౬ ॥

yataḥ pravṛttir bhūtānāṁ yena sarvam idaṁ tatam |
sva-karmaṇā tam abhyarcya siddhiṁ vindati mānavaḥ |

"By worshipping Him — from whom all beings arise,
by whom all this is pervaded —
through one's own work,
a person attains perfection."

The principle that any honest work, offered with the right attitude, becomes a path to God.

BG 18.47 *Echo of 3.35 — better one's own duty imperfectly than another's well*

श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात् ।

स्वभावनियतं कर्म कुर्वन्नाप्नोति किल्बिषम् ॥ १८.४७ ॥

śreyān sva-dharmo viguṇaḥ para-dharmāt sv-anuṣṭhitāt |
svabhāva-nīyataṁ karma kurvan nāpnoti kilbiṣam |

"Better is one's own duty, though imperfect,
than another's duty well performed.
By doing the work prescribed by one's own nature,
one incurs no sin."

ईश्वरः सर्वभूतानां हृद्देशेऽर्जुन तिष्ठति ।

भ्रामयन्सर्वभूतानि यन्त्रारूढानि मायया ॥ १८.६१ ॥

ఈశ్వరః సర్వభూతానాం హృద్దేశేఽర్జున తిష్ఠతి ।

భ్రామయన్సర్వభూతాని యన్త్రారూఢాని మాయయా ॥ ౧౮.౬౧ ॥

īśvaraḥ sarva-bhūtānāṃ hṛd-deśe 'rjuna tiṣṭhati |

bhrāmayan sarva-bhūtāni yantrārūḍhāni māyayā | |

"The Lord, O Arjuna, dwells in the hearts of all beings —
spinning them all by His māyā,
as if mounted on a wheel of machinery."

IAST	संस्कृत	తెలుగు	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>sarva-dharmān</i>	सर्वधर्मान्	సర్వధర్మాన్	SAR-va-DHAR-maan	all dharmas / all forms of duty
<i>parityajya</i>	परित्यज्य	పరిత్యజ్య	pa-ri-TYAJ-ya	abandoning, completely giving up
<i>mām</i>	माम्	మామ్	maam	to Me
<i>ekam</i>	एकम्	ఏకమ్	E-kam	alone, only
<i>śaraṇam</i>	शरणम्	శరణమ్	SHA-ra-nam	refuge, shelter
<i>vraja</i>	व्रज	వ్రజ	VRA-ja	go, take, come
<i>aham</i>	अहम्	అహమ్	A-ham	I
<i>tvām</i>	त्वाम्	త్వామ్	tvaam	you
<i>sarva-pāpebhyaḥ</i>	सर्वपापेभ्यः	సర్వపాపేభ్యః	SAR-va-PAA-pebh-yah	from all sins / from all evil
<i>mokṣayiṣyāmi</i>	मोक्षयिष्यामि	మోక్షయిష్యామి	MOK-sha-yish-YAA-mi	I shall liberate
<i>mā śucaḥ</i>	मा शुचः	మా శుచః	maa SHU-chah	do not grieve, do not mourn

